

Katie Palecek

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EDUCATION: University of Arkansas, Sam M. Walton College of Business

Bachelor of Science in International Business

Major: International Business, Management Concentration

Graduation: May 2027

Minor: Spanish

INTERNATIONAL EXPERIENCE

Semester abroad, Seville, Spain

August 2025 – December 2025

- International Expansion Strategy, Spanish language, and Andalusian cultural studies

Language & Culture Study, Barcelona, Spain

September 2022 – October 2022

- Six-week Immersive Spanish language and cultural studies program

Conservation Program, Thailand

October 2022 – November 2022

- Six-week program exploring sustainability, conservation, and economic development

EXPERIENCE

Project Manager

August 2026 – Present

McMillon Innovation Studio: Experience Fayetteville: Fayetteville, Arkansas

- Lead a multidisciplinary team of 4 students researching the feasibility of a multisport complex and its potential impact on Fayetteville's sports tourism economy
- Direct research across demand, land requirements, development costs, profitability, growth models, and funding opportunities
- Apply human-centered design, stakeholder research and traditional market research to evaluate community needs

Business Developer, Student Business Incubator

January 2025 – August 2026

Wild Bill Pickles, Bentonville, Arkansas

- Revitalized a small food business nearly 10 years after closure through a 10-week entrepreneurship program, rebuilding business model, brand positioning and go-to-market strategy
- Analyzed ingredients, packaging, and supplier costs to improve sourcing decisions, understand unit economics and economies of scale, and identify cost-saving opportunities without sacrificing product differentiation
- Reworked local sourcing, pricing and production strategy while adapting the recipe and ingredients to create a more viable path toward relaunch and sustainable growth.

Recruitment Intern

February 2023 – April 2023

Eirkoo Recruitment, Dublin, Ireland

- Processed and formatted 100+ resumes daily, supporting efficient candidate screening and placement across active searches
- Conducted outreach to 30+ prospective clients and supported candidate placement, interview coordination, and day-to-day recruitment operations

ENGAGEMENT & INVOLVEMENT

Nestle Design Team

January 2025 – Present

McMillon Innovation Studio, University of Arkansas

- Developing innovative solutions to streamline in-store operations for DiGiorno pizza stocking through customer discovery, interviews, and prototype testing
- Conducting repeated testing of prototypes in real-world contexts, refining solutions to enhance usability and efficiency
- Collaborating with cross-disciplinary team members to ideate, implement, and evaluate sustainable and feasible solutions